

Satan's Counterfeit Operations

The Holy Spirit Teaches a Healthy Respect for Satan's Devices

Amen. Open to Luke 11, and we will begin around verse 14.

Hallelujah.

It was not religion that taught me a healthy respect for Satan's operation. Religion said, "You can get overbalanced." Religion came out with either, "Everything is a devil," or "pigs in the parlor," and if you bite your fingernails, you need that cast out of you too. Religion either overplays it or underplays it.

It was finally the Holy Spirit who taught me a healthy respect for Satan's operation. Religion will not teach you the healthy respect you need, because Satan is generally the one who put the offset flavor on religion.

It had to be the Holy Spirit who taught me the healthy respect, the reverent, godly fear, and the reverence for Satan's operation that caused me to be able to operate free and do what I know God has called me to do.

When Jesus said not to be ignorant of Satan's devices, He meant He wanted you to understand how Satan operates. He does not make statements like "wise as serpents, and harmless as doves" without intending for you to understand the wisdom Satan operates under.

General Patton had a German counterpart who wrote a book on tank warfare. The German army had defeated us at one point, and while the German counterpart celebrated the victory and drank all night, Patton stayed up all night studying the book his enemy had written. The next day he knew every move his enemy was going to make, and they defeated him.

The greatest war is won if you do not have to fire a single shot.

This is why Satan created religion. He knew men would have that lack in them through spiritual death. He knew they would reach out for God. He knew all he had to do was provide a god. In doing so, he would cut off the supply line, and men would live and die thinking the afterlife was all set.

Jesus said you need to know your enemy. Be wise as a serpent, yet harmless as a dove. He wanted us to understand the wisdom Satan operates in so we can survive him.

Sure, I have power over all the power of the enemy. But all the power the Holy Ghost has will not do me any good if I become as one who beats the air, expending my energy and life force running down the wrong path, having nothing to do with God, until my whole life is neutralized while I think I served God.

If the light that is in you is darkness, how great is that darkness? If you think you are serving God and you are not, that is religion.

We have more or less made fun of the devil, saying he is stupid and his little devils are stupid and disorganized. They may appear stupid when they are coming out of somebody, but you have to understand that the pressure required to cause them to come out is extreme. They are not in their normal character then. When pressure is applied for them to come out, they are screaming out of control. That is not the calm, cool, collected way Satan really operates.

He has tried to convince us he is dumb, stupid, and disorganized. Wrong. The devil is not stupid, and he is not disorganized.

Jesus Revealed an Organized Kingdom That Cannot Cast Itself Out

Luke 11:14 says:

And he was casting out a devil, and it was dumb.

Before I knew that meant the man could not speak, I thought, "What devil is not dumb?"

And it came to pass, when the devil was gone out, the dumb spake; and the people wondered.

I like that. It still takes place today.

But some of them said, He casteth out devils through Beelzebub the chief of the devils.
And others, tempting him, sought of him a sign from heaven.
But he, knowing their thoughts, said unto them,
Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation;
and a house divided against a house falleth.
If Satan also be divided against himself, how shall his kingdom stand?

Even Satan's kingdom is organized to the point that Jesus said Satan cannot cast himself out. If he did, how would his kingdom stand? Jesus is talking about a highly sophisticated, organized kingdom and operation set against you.

Satan is a smart fellow. When Jesus said to be wise as a serpent and harmless as a dove, He meant Satan has an arsenal full of weapons that can only be combated by the wisdom of God.

We think it is over when we say, "Devil, come out," because what we are most familiar with is casting devils out of people. We know very little about the rest of his operation. Yet if Satan has an arsenal full of weaponry that can only be combated by the wisdom of God, then there must be

operations out there that seduce us a step at a time when our defenses are down, until we walk all the way out of the power of God and great moves are neutralized into dead churches.

How on God's green earth do you think that happens if it is not systematic? Give Satan two generations, and there is not a move he cannot turn back to neutralization. Why? Because his kingdom cannot be divided against itself. There has to be order in his kingdom. He is not stupid. He is highly organized.

Jesus said:

If I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your sons cast them out?
therefore shall they be your judges.
But if I with the finger of God cast out devils,
no doubt the kingdom of God is come upon you.

Then He said:

When a strong man armed keepeth his palace, his goods are in peace:
But when a stronger than he shall come upon him, and overcome him,
he taketh from him all his armour wherein he trusted,
and divideth his spoils.

Jesus was saying, "If I am not casting devils out by the Holy Ghost, where do I get the power to overpower the strong man when he is guarding his goods? Where does that power come from if it is not from the kingdom of God?"

He was also saying, "I just told you Satan cannot cast himself out because his kingdom cannot be divided. If I cast out devils by Satan's power, by whom do your sons cast them out?"

The Pharisees were teaching each generation, but they could not cast devils out. Jesus could. So what He was saying was, "You cannot cast him out, so you are of the devil. I can cast him out, so I am of God. If I can bind the strong man and cast him out of a house, and that power comes from God, then the kingdom of God has come near you because it is in Me."

The Swept and Garnished House Shows the First Level of Organized Resistance

Jesus went on to say something incredible:

When the unclean spirit is gone out of a man,
he walketh through dry places, seeking rest;
and finding none, he saith, I will return unto my house whence I came out.
And when he cometh, he findeth it swept and garnished.
Then goeth he, and taketh to him seven other spirits more wicked than himself;
and they enter in, and dwell there:
and the last state of that man is worse than the first.

These unclean spirits, on the level they walk in, have an assignment to possess people, to get into people and manifest their lusts, power, bondage, and captivity through them. But when one goes out of a man, he wanders through dry places seeking rest and finding none. Finally he comes back to the house he came out of.

I never understood this. It seemed as though he threw some kind of spot inspection on the house. He found it empty, swept, and garnished. Just because he found it that way, it seemed to give him the right to go get seven spirits more wicked than himself, come back, and move into the man.

If those seven were more wicked than himself, how did this low-level devil get seven more ferocious, more powerful devils to go with him?

I can tell you why. That unclean spirit appealed to a power or a ruler of darkness. He said, "There is some kind of revival starting down here. People are getting devils cast out of them. They are starting to get free. I know I got cast out. Mr. Ruler of Darkness, assign seven more wicked spirits, because we have to go back and stop this man. We have to stop this revival."

That is the first level of operation against you. If you do not think it is organized, how did this one weak devil get seven stronger ones to come back with him? Because the ruler commanded it. Because there is organization. Every step you take into God, Satan is organized to step against it. He is not going to let you do anything for God for free.

Greater is He who is in you than he who is in the world. When you know how Satan operates, most of your victory is won because you understand his wisdom and his deception. He neutralizes most people by getting them to follow him. When you know how to stand against him, it is finished. You can walk all the way into God because much of the power you will walk in is understanding your enemy and neutralizing him instead of letting him neutralize you.

Garnished Means the Delivered House Is Ready for Its Walk

What does garnished mean? I once thought it sounded like varnished, as if he swept the house, scrubbed the floor, sanded it, and put varnish on it.

But garnished means elaborately furnished. If you go into an expensive restaurant where they charge thirty dollars for a steak, they put garnishings on it. My wife and I once went into a restaurant like that, and the maitre d' came out with a towel over his arm and asked, "Have you any reservations?" I looked at him and thought, "I should have dressed better."

They brought the dinner. There was a little steak about this big with a whole tree of parsley next to it. They call that garnishings.

When the unclean spirit comes back and inspects the house that just got delivered, he finds it not only emptied but swept and garnished. The old nature has been emptied out. The house has received a new nature. Even the soul has been swept clean. It is elaborately furnished.

The devil looks and says, "I am no match for this person now. I need help." He goes and gets seven more wicked than himself. His intention is to put your light out.

You might as well know, my friend, that for every operation of God, Satan has a counterfeit. It cost much of my life to find this out so I could teach any man or woman of God who wanted to know how to put one foot in front of the other and go from where they are now. I do not care if you are a carpenter or a housewife. This power belongs to you, not just preachers. When you speak, hell should listen. When you want to operate in God, you should have wisdom. When you want to conquer the business world, it is yours, but you have to know how Satan operates, or he will defeat you.

There are eight operations of God: apostle, prophet, teacher, workings of miracles, gifts of healings, helps, governments, and diversities of tongues. Satan goes and gets seven more wicked than himself. Seven plus the one that came out makes eight. He has a counterfeit operation for each.

When he finds a person swept and garnished with a new nature, elaborately furnished, with the Holy Ghost dwelling in him, this man is ready to begin his walk. So that devil will get up to seven more to come, and each step the person tries to take, Satan is ready for it.

I do not want to scare you. You have absolutely nothing to fear. But let me ask you a few questions.

Why can you almost count on two hands in any generation the preachers and believers who are filled with the Holy Ghost and have attained revival status? Why are many called but few chosen? Because you make yourself chosen. The calling is God's part. Making yourself chosen is your part. Being chosen is a qualifying process.

God has chosen every one of you to walk in power, absolute devil-stomping, mountain-moving power that devastates everything you touch. But you are the one who makes yourself chosen to fulfill that position.

If the same thing is available to every evangelist, where are they? What stopped them? Where were they neutralized? If Satan is that smart, do you not think you should learn how he operates?

The War Machine Finds the Level Required to Stop Prayer

God does not want a year to go by, nor one preachers' conference to escape, without us understanding this.

Had I known in the early days of my prayer life that it was an organized onslaught against me, I would have saved myself many years. I did not know who organized it against me. I did not know what was trying to stop me.

The last time I was in Oregon, something scared the living daylights out of me. Half the preachers I had taught to walk in power had been neutralized. Half of them went back to what they had been doing. Prayer was not there. Nothing was left from the old days.

To see the job Satan did on them moved me with a godly, reverent fear. I do not mean fear as terror. I mean a healthy respect for what God has said. It established one thing in me: this is all true. A healthy respect for prayer settled down in me, and I do not think I have lost the edge on it from that day to this.

I know who I am fighting, and I know what is coming. Since I understand this, peace and confidence are building inside me like never before. We are going to finish our course, tear hell up, and take maybe a billion people home with us.

Are you with me?

When the unclean spirit comes back and finds the house swept and garnished, he gets seven more wicked than himself because he says, "I cannot handle this person now." Satan's war machine is instigated. It starts at the bottom and begins to go up. Satan will exert as much power as necessary to find your level. When he finds your level, that is where he will stop you. Many he turns back to the world somewhere along the way. They do not make it anywhere.

Ephesians 6 Describes a Natural Army to Explain a Spiritual One

Go to Ephesians 6. Hallelujah.

Sometimes when I have taught on this, I have scared preachers so badly that they did not think there was any hope. That is not my intention. My intention is to give you hope.

When I taught this the first time and Elaine heard it after God had given it to me, she said, "I can give you a list of two hundred preachers who have been neutralized after once walking in power, just like you are talking about."

I started going back through my life, remembering preachers I had known who had fallen from God. When He showed me the patterns, I realized what had happened to them.

Ephesians 6:10 says:

Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord,
and in the power of his might.

Remember, Paul is concluding the book of Ephesians. After five chapters of incredible teaching, these are his final instructions to stand. He says to be strong in the Lord and in the power of His might. The power of His might means not yours, but His. God wants to flex His muscles for you.

Then he says:

Put on the whole armour of God,
that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.

If His desire is for me to be strong in the Lord and in the power of His might, then His instruction for me to be strong in the Lord is to put on the whole armor of God so I can stand against the wiles of the devil.

There is no choice about whether the devil is going to attack. The choice He gives you is whether you are going to be able to stand against the wiles of the devil. To do so, you must put on the whole armor of God.

Why?

For we wrestle not against flesh and blood,
but against principalities,
against powers,
against the rulers of the darkness of this world,
against spiritual wickedness in high places.

For the longest time I did not understand what he was saying. I thought he meant our war is not just against the carnal nature of the flesh, but against the devil's empowerment of the flesh. But that is not what he was saying.

He used the battle array of a Roman foot soldier, loins girded about with truth, breastplate of righteousness, helmet of salvation, sword of the Spirit, and sandals of peace, because he was saying that what you are wrestling against is every bit as organized as the Roman Empire, from Caesar down to centurions and foot soldiers.

There is not a natural army marching against Tulsa that requires us to put on natural armor. But Satan is just as organized with his principalities, powers, rulers of darkness, and spiritual wickedness in high places. From Satan down to the unclean spirits that launch themselves against you, this army is smart.

The storm will come to the house on the rock. The choice is not whether the storm will come, but whether you are going to dig and find the rock to put your house on. The choice is not whether the wiles of the devil will come. They will come. The choice is whether you will put the armor on, because that is the only way you will be able to stand against him.

Satan prefers the neutralization of deception. If he can get you to sit there and do nothing, he has already done his job.

Wiles Means Methodical Penetration, Not a Childish Tantrum

The word wiles does not mean a child throwing a toy, hitting another child in the head, screaming, falling down, and kicking. Wiles means the methodical, militaristic plots, ploys, and schemes of Diablo, the devil, to neutralize you.

When I found out what Diablo meant, I saw that Jesus gave that name to those unclean spirits that penetrate people's lives. Devil means penetration. The phrase "the wiles of the devil" describes methodical, militaristic methods and schemes to penetrate your life.

The picture is one single, harmless drop of water falling on a rock day after day, week after week, month after month, year after year, decade after decade, century after century, millennium after millennium, until one day that single drop has penetrated the rock and cut a hole all the way through it.

That is why Paul named every piece of armor that covers your whole operation, so you can stand against Satan's schemes and plans for penetration.

If the devil cannot take me out, he will go for my children. He does not care if it takes two hundred years to neutralize a move. He will keep dropping that water until he penetrates. If he can take it away from me in my generation, he is glad. If he cannot, he will take the next decade or generation.

Truth Is the First Armor Because God Cannot Add Himself to a Lie

Let us talk about one piece of the armor in the light of Satan's schemes to neutralize and penetrate your life.

The first piece of armor, the bottom rung of the ladder, is:

Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth.

In Ephesians 4, the first thing Paul says about putting off the old man and putting on the new is to put away lying and be renewed in the spirit of your mind in true holiness. The first thing off is lying. Then in Ephesians 6, the first thing on is truth.

Off with lying. On with truth.

Why is the first thing to put away lying? Because if your life is based on a lie, if it is built on a lie, then the foundation is weak. If the foundation is weak, how are you going to put a building on it?

I thought loins girded about with truth meant equipping myself with the Word of God. Then I found out the sword of the Spirit was the aggressive weapon of God, the usage of His Word. So what was loins girded about with truth? He was talking about your personal integrity, your personal life of truth.

In God there is no darkness at all, which means He cannot lie. If there is no darkness in Him, He cannot add Himself to your lie.

"Brother Roberson, I do not really lie. I just mislead people to believe something that is not exactly true."

I am sorry. That is deception.

Jesus said:

Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God.

In Him is no darkness at all. He cannot lie, and He cannot add Himself to your lie, no matter how minute it is. In God's immutability, the fact that He cannot change nor be changed, the thing He uses to illustrate His unchanging attributes and character is that He cannot lie.

I found out the only reason I exaggerated, misled people, or blatantly lied was because I did not believe the final solution God would bring to my problem would far outweigh the temporary solution I fixed by lying.

Why did He say loins? Abraham believed God that his seed would number as the stars of heaven and the sand of the sea. From Abraham's loins came seed. Long after Abraham was gone, his seed continued to perpetuate itself and become strong in the earth.

Lies have life in themselves. Every time you father a lie, even long after you quit lying and long after you are gone, that lie continues to destroy people. That is why your loins must be girded about with truth.

Blessed are the pure in heart. They shall see God. A pure man is a man who operates in the total absence of deceit. He is what he says, and he says what he is.

This is when Nathanael became an absolute hero of mine. Jesus said:

Behold an Israelite indeed, in whom is no guile!

Nathanael said, "When did You know me?"

Jesus said, "Before Philip called thee, when thou wast under the fig tree, I saw thee."

Nathanael said, "You are the Son of God."

Jesus said, "Because I said that, you believe? You will see angels ascending and descending upon the Son of man."

What Nathanael was saying was, "Nobody knows what it has cost me to walk free of deception, to say what I am and be what I say. Nobody would know that unless he lived with me. You are Him."

When you decide to pay the price to put that piece of armor on, you develop a capacity to understand an infallible God who cannot lie, who has exalted His Word above His name, who is the same yesterday, today, and forever. Because you have stopped lying, you receive a capacity by the Spirit to understand a God who will not lie.

When He says something, He means it. When you put your word out there, you are ready to pay the price for it. That is armor Satan cannot penetrate.

No matter how hard he tries, my name and my word are my bond. You will not get inside my armor and defeat me, because I know your wiles and I know how to stand against you. I will not lie, mislead, or misrepresent truth. Nor will I let you stand in my presence and live a lie.

When exaggeration and misleading begin, Satan comes in behind the armor and takes his position. You say, "I rebuke you, Satan. Get out of my operation. Leave my money alone."

He says, "Stand against my wiles when you stop that lying."

That is just one piece.

Peace Gives the Footing Satan Cannot Force Off Balance

I could go through the armor for you. I once thought the sandals of peace were to go from village to village preaching the gospel. But Paul was talking about a Roman foot soldier. Sandals were created for forced marches. Part of Rome's strategy was to march all night and surprise the enemy in the morning.

Those sandals could go through streams and dry out. They allowed the soldier to stand sure-footed on any terrain.

That is what the peace of God does for you. It causes you to stand toe to toe with the devil on solid footing. When you operate in aggressive peace, it is a weapon of God. If Satan cannot force you, badger you, or entice you, he cannot control you. Peace gives you a footing that he cannot shove off your foundation.

Glory be to God.

You need to put this armor on. That kind of transformation and mortification will not come outside the Holy Spirit's power. You have to learn how to release Him on the inside of you.

The day you decide to separate yourself for an hour or two a day and let the Holy Ghost steadily flow through your spirit in the supernatural language of tongues is the day you decide to walk into the classroom of the Holy Spirit and sit down. The Person at the chalkboard is the Holy Ghost. He will begin to teach you revelation and power, all things pertaining to transformation. He will become your teacher concerning godly things and power.

Hallelujah.

Praying in Tongues Will Not Let a Liar Stay Comfortable

I remember what giving up lying cost me.

When I first met Rosalie, she was singing in the choir. My God, I loved her from the day I saw her. I was a cowboy kind of rough guy. I rode a horse to church in the middle of Los Angeles, up the river, because the church was on the river in Compton.

I told God, "Just give me her, and I will serve You."

Before I was saved, you should have heard me. I really laid it on. The biggest lie I told her was, "I do not lie." That is part of our equipment. Elks fight each other. Rams fight each other on top of mountains. We lie.

After I was saved and filled with the Holy Ghost, I did not have to lie about it anymore except when people would bring up the past. They would say, "Dave did not do that. Dave would never have done that."

The more I prayed in the Holy Ghost, the more God brought this to me. Let me tell you two things that will not happen: you will not pray extended hours in the Holy Ghost and remain a liar. In fact, you will not remain anything, really. That is the edification process. You will not be built up in God without turning things loose.

Jude says:

These be they who separate themselves, sensual, having not the Spirit.

But ye, beloved, building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Ghost.

You build yourself above that sensual-dominated mess by praying in the Holy Ghost.

Your prayer life will go only so far before the Holy Ghost starts purging the love of money, lying, and everything else. Somewhere along the line, you have to decide which one you will give up: your prayer life or what He is trying to purge. Both will not live in the same vessel.

Eventually the Holy Ghost has to dive back down into your spirit, where that little ball of your new nature exists, and hide there while you do all those ugly things. When you pray in tongues, that opens a door and lets Him out. Either you give those things up, or He goes back in there to live and you lose your prayer life. Both will not exist in the same temple.

I was praying extended hours and fasting extended times. God kept bringing this to me: "I want you to give that up. I want you to tell her the truth."

"God, the image she has had of me all my life. I cannot."

He would say, "Tell her."

"Okay, I will tell her tomorrow."

He let that go for a long time. Tomorrow would come, and I would be praying in the Holy Ghost. It would surface again and bother me. He would wake me up at night. I would say, "Tomorrow." He would say, "Okay."

Finally I said, "Tomorrow," and He said, "No. Tell her."

I said, "Okay."

The next day I said, "I want to take you to a fine restaurant and talk to you." Later the kids were playing in the cage at Burger King.

"Order anything you want. I am going to spend some money on you."

I said, "Remember when I was first saved and people said, 'Dave did not do that. Dave would never have done that'? Remember that?"

She said, "Yes."

"Well, I lied."

"What?"

"I lied."

"I cannot hear you."

"I lied."

She said, "About what?"

"Remember when they said, 'Dave did not do that'? I did."

"Oh my God. What did you expect? You were just an old sinner boy. Is there anything else?"

"That is it. I am leaving."

I walked out and started over the bridge. I heard the car pull up beside me.

"Get in the car."

"No."

"Get in the car."

"No."

She said, "Oh, come on. I know what that cost you. I trust you more now than I ever have. I know what that cost you."

It did something, folks. When you decide to pay the price, it develops a capacity in you to understand an infallible God who cannot lie. When He says, "You are healed," you are healed.

Please do not feel bad about where you are walking. You made it this far. That kind of mortification comes from the Holy Spirit.

The Spirit Uncovers Whatever Blocks a Hundredfold Walk

Jesus said:

Is a candle lit to be put under a bushel, or under a bed?
and not to be set on a candlestick?
For there is nothing hid, which shall not be manifested.

These are those who bring forth a hundredfold. Is a candle lit to be hidden under a table? No. It is to ignite the room and expose all the dark objects hidden in the room.

What hidden things is He talking about? Anything keeping you from a hundredfold walk. God is willing to uncover it for you if you want Him to. The way you ignite that candle and shine light into the darkness is to begin praying in the Holy Ghost.

For every operation of God, Satan has his eight operations. He has a counterfeit for every operation God has. Every time a person graduates into a realm or a calling, Satan has an operation against that realm and calling to try to stop him.

Once you put on the armor of God, he does not have a chance. That is where the power of God comes from: unstoppable power. That is where longevity comes from, understanding God's operation on the inside of you.

You will not pray very long in the Holy Ghost, speaking mysteries, before He begins to purge things out of you. Each time something is purged, you can rest assured that a piece of armor comes into existence. It blocks the devil from defeating you in that area again as you walk in the fullness of His armor.

When Jesus ascended on high, He led captivity captive and gave gifts unto men. He gave apostles, prophets, and teachers. You could say the counterfeit this way: Satan ascended on high according to his authority and power and gave positions to his unclean spirits. First, he gave principalities. Second, he gave powers. Third, he instigated rulers of the darkness of this world. Then spiritual wickedness in high places.

In the same way God set into motion apostles, prophets, and teachers, Satan set into authority the counterfeit operation.

The Message Turns From Teaching to Deliverance From Reasoning's Destruction

I am going to have to stop that part of it right there because there is something He wants to do right now.

I know this is a hard message. You want longevity. The blessings do not work too well without it. We talk about blessings and blessings and blessings, but most of them have been taken away from us, and we wonder why we are always on the sidelines.

We run across the country looking for God mostly because we do not know God. We are so busy looking at finished products that we do not know how to stop and become one. We are so busy reading other people's books that we do not know how to tear hell up so badly that books are written about us.

Why? Because we are stopped at the gate. There is no use preaching the glory if you will never see it.

He wanted me to tell you something because of what He wants to do here. There are a few people here. As a matter of fact, six. He will take eight because there are a couple of you just beginning this. If this is really necessary for you, if God cannot step in now, it is going to cost you a lot of time.

When I defeated the first level of devils and went to a camp-meeting status, sometimes seeing fifteen hundred people saved or filled with the Holy Ghost in a six-week period in America, and ran the engine time out on three twin-engine airplanes, hopping sometimes to three camp meetings a week, Satan was forced to move his operation up against me even if hell could not afford the soldiers. I forced them into it.

There are two things the devil will not tolerate: aggressive soul winning and a prayer life that will not relent. Whether you are ready for it or not, if you run down the street getting people saved, you will not go unnoticed. If you have a kind of prayer life that cannot be stopped, Satan is obligated to keep appealing to a higher power until he finally finds the level necessary to stop you.

Most of us get mad at the color of the carpet, blame everybody and everything else, and stop praying. But when it got to that level with me, one day in my motel room, something came in, some kind of presence. Nobody had ever told me about it. Later I named him Mr. Destruction of Reasonings.

When he hit, there is no way I can describe the pressure and torment I came under. I had no peace in my mind. The only time I was out from under it was when I stood under the anointing at night ministering in the service. I got to where I could hardly look at my Bible. I had no peace unless

something occupied the thoughts in my mind every moment of the day. I had to watch television all the time, or that thing would occupy my mind. It was horrible torment.

When I got dressed for the service, God would walk in and meet me, and I could minister. But there is no way to describe those few years of torment when that thing tried to destroy me.

First, it badgered me until I could not pray anymore. When I finally conceded to no more prayer, thinking, "This just has to be by grace. I will minister the rest of my life like I am," and when it knew it had defeated my prayer life, it moved the pressure to another zone and tried to get me across the line into immorality.

I had too much holiness root. I could not make the trip.

My reasonings felt destroyed. My emotions felt destroyed. For that period of time it felt like I had no control over them. I walked the floor, wrung my hands, sweated, and hated myself for myself. I would do anything to get out from under it. I would turn on the television and sit there in a daze. It was that strong.

The only comparison I can make is the description I heard of a preacher on drugs. When withdrawals started, the pressure was so tormenting and strong that he would want to get a stick and beat his own mother to get the money out of her purse so he could buy drugs. That is how strong this was.

From that time, I wanted to erect a bronze statue to Jimmy Swaggart for all the people he had gotten born again. I knew talent had exalted him, and when the devil broadsided him, I knew he did not know what hit him either. Many times he would play that golden piano and tears would roll. He would say, "How could God fill the altar while we live in this standard of hypocrisy?"

God will walk a long way with a man in His grace. Finally, at a Marilyn Hickey meeting, when I was preaching at the Mile High Conference with her, God got to me. That is when I canceled all my meetings, learned what it meant to fast, learned what it meant to go back in, and broke it.

The result of breaking that thing was the series on aggressive peace, the weapon of God.

When I started to cry a little while ago, it was because He told me there are a handful of you who know what I am talking about. There are two levels of it. One is in your reasonings. It has been so strong, especially with immorality, that if you have been able to resist it, you do not know how much longer you can hold up.

I am telling you, just as surely as you are sitting there, that is a presence that comes to your ministry on assignment to stop you. Since He set me free, there seems to be an anointing present to break that thing, to recapture you for prayer, to put a new fire and dedication in you. Even if you did not pray, it would still take the devil quite a while to get the drive to pray back out of you.

He stopped me in the middle of what I wanted to do. I was busy systematically pulling down the resistance in your emotions to what I was saying until you accepted it, and He stopped me.